

Saying your target speech sound

Games to play at single sound, sound+ vowel and word level

When practicing speech sounds, please remember to....

- Find a quiet space to work
- Make it fun! Everything should be a game
- Use the child's interests where possible
- Little and often is best
- Aim for 50-100 repetitions within each session
- Vary the activities you use and include more active games where you can
- Use either picture cue cards to represent your target sound or the written letter



The following activities will help your child to produce sounds more clearly and will make therapy more fun and motivating for your child. Please consult your Speech and Language Therapist for guidance as to what approach to take, the sounds to work on and at what level e.g. the sound in isolation, sound + vowel or word level and beyond.

Hide and seek



Sounds in isolation: Make copies of the sound picture or letter you are working on. Hide them around the room or out in the garden or playground. When your child finds the card encourage them to say the sound. Initially you may need to model the sound for them, making sure they can see your mouth and how you make the sound.

Make it harder: Add a vowel: Repeat the game but also have a pile of vowel cards. When the child finds a sound card get them to select a vowel card from the pile and encourage them to say their target sound the vowel selected (e.g. kee, kah, kor)

In words: Repeat the game but instead hide word picture cards. When your child finds them, encourage your child to say what they are e.g. 'car' 'cat' 'cap'.

In simple phrases: Use picture cards that contain the target sound. When your child finds a picture encourage them to say what it is and put into a simple phrase e.g. 'red car' Sentence level: As above but encourage your child to put the word found into a sentence e.g. 'I've found a red car'.



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Fishing



Print out some paper fish and attach a paperclip to each fish . A stick with string or fishing line with a magnet at the end makes a great rod. Using the paperclip, attach a picture of the target sound or word on the back of each fish (alternatively use a commercial fishing game).

Each time your child catches a fish, they must try to produce the target sound/word.

Make it harder: If your child can say the target word confidently in words (such as 'sun'), ask them to add a word in a simple phrase e.g. 'yellow sun' and if they are confident at this level, move onto generating sentences using the target words.

Obstacle course



Create an obstacle course, which involves lots of exciting movements for example, skipping, hopping, running backwards, crab walking, going in/on/under. At different points in the obstacle course place a picture of the sound/ word and the child must attempt to say it before moving on. Have a race, or time trials, when your child is familiar with the course.

Make it harder: If your child can say the target word confidently in words ask them to add a word in a simple phrase e.g. 'yellow sun' and if confident at this level move onto generating sentences using the target words.

Washing line



Create a washing line with a long piece of string and pegs. Your child has to say the sound / word on the picture before they can peg it up on the line.

Make it harder: If your child can produce the target sound confidently in words, try in simple phrases and then longer sentences.

Memory picture pairs



Have two copies of the sound / word pictures turned face down on the floor. Take turns trying to find a matching pair, saying all the pictures as you go. Remember to only put out as many picture pairs as your child can cope with. Remember that the challenge is saying the correct sounds / words.

Make it harder: If your child can produce the target sound confidently in words, try in simple phrases and then longer sentences.

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Make a mobile



You will need: A wire coat hanger or a stick, different lengths of string and copies of your target sound / word pictures. Tie them together to make a mobile to hang. Colouring the pictures will make the mobile look brighter and more colourful. Again, the child must say the target sounds / words before hole punching, colouring and tying the knots. The more practice the better.

Make it harder: If your child can produce the target sound confidently in words, try in simple phrases and then longer sentences.

Skittles



Place your target sound / word pictures under the skittles. Your child must roll the ball and knock down the skittles to reveal the target picture and must say the target sound / words revealed.

Make it harder: If your child can produce the target sound confidently in words try in simple phrases and then longer sentences. If they knock down multiple pictures can they create a sentence using all of them? E.g. 'I can see a car, kite and a cat'

Posting



Play a posting game, role-playing being a postman. Stamp or mark the letters (sound / word pictures) before posting them in the box. Make a box out of a shoebox, milk carton etc. Your child has to say each sound / word before posting.

Make it harder: If your child can produce the target sound confidently in words, try saying in simple phrases e.g. 'post car' and then longer sentences saying 'I am posting/stamping a car'

Leapfrog



Your child can pretend to be a frog, jumping on to lily pads. Try not to fall or you will be in the water! Use cushions as lily pads. A sound / word picture is to be placed on each lily pad. Your child must say the target sound / word before jumping on to the next lily pad. Have fun with frog noises.

Make it harder: If your child can produce the target sound confidently in words, try saying in simple phrases 'jump on car' and then longer sentences 'I am jumping on a red car'.



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Scavenger Hunt



Go around the house with your child and find things that have the target sound in them. For example, if your child is struggling with the 'k' sound you could collect things such as a comb, cap, toy car, cup and key. Give them clues about what to find e.g. 'It starts with 'c' and you drink from it'. Talk about what you have found, emphasizing your child's target sound.

Make it harder: If your child can produce the target sound confidently in words, try saying in simple phrases and then longer sentences.

What's in the bag?



Put the set of objects that contain your child's target sound in a bag. Get your child to feel inside and try and guess what the object is. Pull it out and see if they were right, emphasising the target sound.

Make it harder: If your child can produce the target sound confidently in words encourage them to say it in simple phrases and then longer sentences. Get them to describe the objects they find e.g. 'The car is red and has wheels'.

Draw it!



Draw things that start with the target sound and see if your child can guess what you are drawing. If you have a child who likes to draw, see if they can draw the pictures, or colour them in. Make sure you talk about the items and create lots of opportunities to say the sound you are practising.

Make it harder: If your child can produce the target sound confidently in words, try saying in simple phrases, talk about the colour of the pictures e.g. 'yellow sun' and then try in longer sentences e.g. 'I've drawn a big yellow sun'.

Scrap book



Collect pictures of your child's target sound from the internet or from magazines and cut and stick these pictures into a book. Talk about what you've found initially using single words and then once they are confident, move onto saying simple phrases and then sentences.



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Simon says...



Play Simon Says with your child, and make sure you use the target sound. For example, if you were working on words beginning with "s", you could say "touch your socks" or "pretend to eat soup" or "pretend to be sad" 'sit down'. You need to make sure you ask the child what they did afterwards, otherwise you are practising the sounds, rather than them!

I spy...



With older children play 'I spy with my little eye something beginning with...(remember to use the letter sound not the letter name). With younger children if they find this too difficult use descriptive words e.g. 'I spy an animal that goes 'miaow.' 'I spy something that you wear when you go outside'

Sound or word of the day



Have one target sound or word that you focus on and encourage your child to use this word or sound as often as possible throughout the day. When you catch them doing it, praise their efforts and reward them with a sticker or something that motivates them

Commercial games



You can use a range of commercial games that you may already have. The idea being that your child has a turn at saying their speech sound, word, phrase or sentence and then has a turn at the game. Some games which you could use include:

Pop up Pirate
Puzzles
Fishing game

Crocodile Dentist
Buckaroo
Mr Potato Head



Useful websites and apps

www.twinkl.co.uk See speech resources in the Speech, Language and Communication

www.blacksheepress.co.uk This website contains a wealth of speech and language resources.

mommyspeechtherapy.co.uk This has free downloadable picture resources

Articulation Station Pro app - Little Bee Speech

Articulation scenes app - Smarty ears



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